



Ocean Energy

Toshiba and IHI are working together on building a ocean energy power generation system <http://dgit.in/OceanEner>



Kim to the rescue

Kim Dotcom offered hackers vouchers for his Mega service in exchange to restoring PSN, Xbox Live services <http://dgit.in/KimVoucher>



Every month we highlight some aspiring tech writers and their spirited attempt to get published in the magazine. Let's have more!

How to create your own blog

Blogging isn't dead, it's just become less frivolous, and the wheat has been separated from the chaff. If you're serious about what you do, this guide from our now regular Digit Squad writer Praneet will help you get started



Praneet Sah

Well, what's a blog? It's also a website, the only difference is that, you use it to share things with public that you love to and to earn money. Starting a blog doesn't require a team or a lot of investment but it does require dedication and a little time. I've seen tons of people starting off with their blogs with great enthusiasm but within 2-3 months, falling apart.

Now before we go on, I assume that you have decided the topic on which you'll blog and also a good name for your blog.

As of now, the most popular blogging services are Blogger and WordPress. Both of them serve the same purpose, but with different powers. Blogger is made for beginners and for those who can't afford expenses. Whereas WordPress is made for advanced users and for those who have money (a little would also do). I'll explain more ahead, but before that, you would want an address like "someblog.com" or "someblog.in"; and to get this address you'll need to buy it (and there's no way to get it for free). I personally use bigrock.in and there's a little trick to get a .com domain name for ₹99. All you need to do is, open google.com and then search for ".com for 99" and look out for the ads where one would say something like ".COM Domain Names @ ₹99". Check that the URL is from Bigrock and then click on it and you'll land on a special page which will give you a ".com" domain for ₹99. Now think of a good domain name for your blog, search for its availability and then buy it.

Now the next thing is to decide which blogging service you will go with. Let me give you an introduction to all of them and the steps to set them up.

Blogger

This is a service offered by Google and the best part about it is that you don't ever need to pay for hosting and this really saves

a you a lot of money. In general, hosting a domain would cost you anything about 2-10K a year. There are specialised hosting services too, with tons of complex settings, but with Blogger you really don't need to care about all the back-end programs. But, it compromises on a few aspects. Limitation of plugins and flexibility to customise is the biggest drawback. There are just a handful of plugins available for Blogger and it also doesn't have



those premium themes which WordPress has to offer. Apart from all this, Google is free to use your articles and your content anywhere. But all this shouldn't let you not choose Blogger, because here you'll never face any downtime and your blog can't be hacked easily since Google is behind you. And just because it's free, I personally use this for my blog and recommend this service to anyone who can't afford hosting or maybe who don't want a lot of bells and whistles.

So now how do we get started with it? That's easy and all you need to do is to go over to blogger.com and sign in with your Gmail account. Now click on "New Blog" and a pop-up will